

Orchestrated Onboarding Meeting Templates

Overview

Onboarding customers is the most important part of the customer journey because when you carefully monitor and engage customers throughout rollout, you're on a path to a lucrative customer relationship.

Orchestrated Onboarding means delivering a proactive and prescriptive process to familiarize new customers with your products and services. Each stage of the Orchestrated Onboarding Framework, shown below, includes important meetings to ensure alignment between internal and customer teams. You are welcome to tailor meeting details to ensure it meets the needs of your organization and your customers.



Orchestrated Onboarding Meetings

This guide includes overviews, pre-work, meeting agendas, and post-work for the following meetings along the Orchestrated Onboarding journey:

[Internal handoff](#)
[Customer handoff](#)

[Kickoff](#)
[Review](#)

Internal Handoff Meeting

The internal handoff aligns internal teams and transitions for a successful transition when an account moves from the buyer journey to the customer journey. Generally, the internal handoff happens during the Handoff stage. However, when companies need to recognize revenue quickly, the internal handoff happens before the deal is signed in the Embark stage.

Internal handoff pre-work

- Customer Success (CS) Manager tracks accounts in pipeline and notifies Customer Success Manager (CSM) of new accounts on the horizon
- CSM schedules internal handoff meeting with sales rep
- Sales rep ensures opportunity, account details, and success plan are updated in systems and available for other teams to review
- CSM reviews the success plan, account and opportunity details to answer these questions:
 - Who is the customer?
 - Which products and services did they buy?
 - What is their motivation for using the products?
 - Who are the key contacts?
 - What are the terms of the sale?
 - What are the customer's goals?

Internal handoff meeting

- Attendees: CSM, Onboarding lead, if appropriate; Sales Rep, Sales Engineer
- Timeframe: Just before or just after the deal closes
- Time needed: 45 to 60 minutes
- Agenda
 - Review opportunity and account details in CRM
 - Review success plan
 - Address any concerns and gaps
 - Review whether the appropriate services are included to ensure customer is onboarded and implemented successfully
 - If not make sure they are added to the deal before it closes
 - Discuss expectations set by the pre-sales team
 - Share what's needed to transfer the relationship
 - Details about the key stakeholders, decision makers, influencers; as well as nuances about their personalities
 - Roles and responsibilities: Discuss the individuals the Sales team worked with during the sales cycle versus who will be engaged during onboarding and beyond
 - Technical capabilities: How technically savvy are the new users? Do they need hand-holding? Are they process oriented? What's the best way to engage?
 - What was the most successful form of communication with this customer? Phone / email / weekly meetings?
 - Any gotchas and pain points?
 - Any timelines and commitments promised?

Internal handoff post-work

- CSM updates the CRM and success plan with what was learned during the internal handoff
- Sales Rep schedules the customer handoff with the new account
- CSM prepares the agenda for the customer handoff

Customer Handoff Meeting

The customer handoff meeting is a strategic meeting held during the handoff stage, usually just after the deal is signed. The customer handoff transitions the relationship from the sales reps to the CSM or other post-sales teams, to provide continuity in the relationship with your company. The customer handoff meeting also aligns customer teams on the objectives for buying your product. Some companies call this the customer stakeholder meeting because it is important for customer teams to understand what was purchased and why, and they need to hear it directly from their stakeholder. The customer handoff is a strategic relationship builder, not a project planning or kickoff meeting.

Customer handoff pre-work

- Conduct the internal handoff meeting
- Update the success plan with everything you know from the pre-sales journey and send a copy of the plan to attendees before the meeting, so they are ready to discuss and update the plan
- Prepare conversation starters: research shows that small talk helps build trust, which is just what you need when starting new relationships
- Schedule the customer handoff as soon as possible: ideally within five to 10 days of the deal close, or even before close if it makes sense with your timelines

Customer handoff meeting

- Attendees
 - Internal attendees: Include the sales rep, sales engineer, if needed; CSM, head of CS, if your customer is a key account; and implementation lead, if appropriate
 - Customer attendees: It is critical for the customer's executive sponsor to be included, as well as the project lead, implementation lead and their team, if appropriate
- Timeframe: Just before or just after the deal closes
- Time needed: 30 to 45 minutes
- Agenda
 - Introductions
 - Sales Rep kicks off the meeting and then introduces the CSM into the relationship and how they will lead things moving forward
 - CSM introduces themselves and connects with the people in the meeting
 - Each attendee introduces themselves, and shares their roles and responsibilities
 - Confirm points of contact within the account for the CSM to engage with moving forward
 - Review, validate, and update the success plan, making sure customer teams are aligned with what was determined during pre-sales
 - Discuss and clarify business objectives for the product purchase and implementation
 - Define roles and responsibilities
 - Review the timeline, next steps, and who is to be involved
 - Address risks, gaps, and concerns

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- Understand what matters to the customer and how they will measure success
 - Help the customer understand where they are accountable, and how that will be tracked
 - Schedule the project kickoff meeting with the implementation teams
 - Determine and schedule the meeting cadence moving forward
 - Schedule the first business review while you have the business sponsor on the call to make sure they attend that review

Customer handoff post-work

- Update the success plan with what you learned during the customer handoff
- Send the updated success plan to the customer sponsor and teams to sign off
- Schedule meetings with customers teams
- Bonus: Send a handwritten card and/or small gift

Kickoff Meeting

After the handoff meetings you start the Kickoff stage. The kickoff meeting is a tactical meeting centered on the implementation: project plans, roles, responsibilities, timelines, and deliverables in order to kick off a successful deployment and go live.

Kickoff meeting pre-work

- CSM reviews success plan
- CSM or implementation consultant create a shared project plan and assets to review with the customer.
 - Include details about implementation, consulting services, adoption, and training, how they fit together, and who does what and when
- Determine how to track accountability and timelines for both your teams and the customer's teams
- Consider whether the customer has required actions before the kickoff meeting and communicate them to the customer
 - **Example:** It might be helpful for the customer to have payment gateway plan in place before you meet
- Invite attendees and send the agenda

Kickoff meeting

- Attendees
 - Internal attendees: CSM, onboarding and implementation team leads, as needed
 - Customer attendees: Project team lead, team members, and others, as needed
 - Timeframe: Within five to 10 business days after the customer handoff meeting.
 - Time needed: 60 minutes
 - Agenda
 - Introductions: Introduce members of customer and company teams, share locations, roles, and an interesting fact about yourselves
 - Review the success plan and fine tune, if needed
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- Review the process for working together to onboard and implement your product
 - Provide an overview of onboarding, implementation, consulting, and training services, and how they fit together
 - Review the project plan, timeline, and dependencies
 - Discuss roles and responsibilities with user flows and swim lanes, if appropriate
 - Cover what the customer is responsible for and how will that be tracked
 - Discuss meeting cadence
 - Review how to log support tickets, if appropriate
 - Review how to access resources like knowledge articles, how-to videos, self-paced training, documentation
 - Next steps and action items

Kickoff meeting post-work

- Immediately follow up with the customer with access to all the assets covered in the kickoff meeting
- Update the project plan, share it with the new customer teams, and let them know their action items, and when you next meet
- Prepare for next meeting

Review Meeting

Reviews are formal and strategic discussions with key stakeholders. The purpose is to keep learning from customers, to maximize customer value and expansion. The first review meeting happens during the Review stage of the Orchestrated Onboarding framework. It allows you to quickly rectify changes needed in this new account, as well as provide feedback on how to improve your onboarding program for existing and future customers. You continue with regular review meetings during the Expand stage at a cadence that makes sense for you and for your customers.

Review meeting pre-work

- Review and update the success plan; update any objectives, note quick wins achieved, and metrics of success
- Prepare metrics including product usage, support tickets, engagement activities, NPS, and customer health score, plus any benchmarking across the company's industry or across similar size companies
- Research news about the company and team on their website, press releases, LinkedIn, Glassdoor, social media, Crunchbase
- Prepare meeting slide deck including metrics and visuals
- Procure swag, promotional items with your company logo, to provide during an in-person meeting, or to ship to the customer for remote meetings, if appropriate

The review meeting

- Attendees:
 - Internal teams: CSM, onboarding specialist / team, if needed; product managers, if needed; sales rep, if needed; executives, if needed;

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- Customer teams: business sponsor, project lead, team members as needed
 - Time frame: About 90 days after the deal closed
 - Time needed: 60 to 90 minutes
 - Agenda
 - Introductions: Take a moment to catch up with people you already know and to connect with those joining the meeting for the first time
 - Updates: Review and update the success plan together. Go over the initial goals defined at the handoff meeting and then share the progress made against those goals
 - Now you are about 90 days into the project, have goals shifted?
 - Are there blockers that need to be discussed?
 - Include data and metrics here as much as possible.
 - Wins and feedback: Take a moment to celebrate how far you have come together
 - If that's not the case, determine how to partner to advance the project moving forward
 - Usage and benchmarking data: Customers love to know how they compare to similar accounts, so share what is appropriate and meaningful for this account.
 - Best practices and recommendations: Guide the account on key areas that provide impact for them.
 - Customer initiatives and roadmap: Learn about your customer's current priorities
 - Are there areas where you, your products, and/or your teams can help them progress easier, faster, more affordably?
 - New products and solution roadmap: Take the opportunity to briefly share what's on your product roadmap; if appropriate, invite the product manager to share this information
 - Questions, answers, discussions: Make time for general discussion, to answer questions, and to address concerns.
 - Schedule next review meeting: Determine the ongoing review meeting cadence and who attends
 - Make it your goal to finish every review meeting with the next one already on the calendar.
 - Action items and next steps: Capture all action items, next steps, their owners and dates

Review meeting post-work

- Email all participants with an overview of what was discussed, decisions made, a copy of metrics and slides, and details of next steps and who is accountable
 - Enter tasks / calls to actions in the appropriate systems and assign to owners and dates
 - If appropriate, send a hand-written thank you note
 - Update the success and project plans with next steps, new goals, dates, owners, risks, etc.
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Provided by
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Customer onboarding expert, [Donna Weber](#), helps high growth companies create clients for life. Her boutique consulting firm provides advisory services, assessments, strategy, and orchestrated programs to onboard, engage, and enable your clients.

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